

Unit -2

7 types of listening that can change your life and work.

The importance of listening can't be overstated.

While [learning to communicate what you want to say is important](#), knowing how to listen using different types of listening skills is just as crucial for communication.

Not only can it help you process information on different levels, but it can also help you build relationships with others.

That's because listening goes deeper than just hearing.

It's also much more than listening to the words someone else is saying. While this is one type of listening, it isn't the only one that matters.

Let's discuss the various types of listening and why listening is important for helping you advance your career and life.

7 types of listening skills

1. Informational listening
2. Discriminative listening
3. Biased listening
4. Sympathetic listening

- 5. Comprehensive listening
- 6. Empathetic or therapeutic listening
- 7. Critical listening

There are several types of listening you can develop both at home and at work.

Let's explore seven of these types of listening, why they matter, and what they can look like:

1. Informational listening

When you want to learn something, you'll use informational listening to understand and retain information.

It usually takes a high level of concentration to perform this type of listening. That's because you [need to be highly engaged](#) to understand a new concept.

You also need to apply critical thinking to what you are learning. This is so you can understand what you're learning within the context of relevant information.

Some examples of informational listening include:

- Work training
- Self-paced learning at home or at work
- Listening to an educational ebook
- [Coaching](#)

When you know how to use informational listening, you empower yourself to become a better learner. By actively

learning and improving yourself, you can become a more valuable asset in your place of work.

You can also feel more fulfilled when you pursue your passions and learn something new at home.

2. Discriminative listening

Discriminative listening is the first listening type that you're born with.

Everyone innately has discriminative listening skills.

You use this type of listening before you even know how to understand words. Instead of relying on words, discriminative listening uses tone of voice, verbal cues, and other changes in sound.

Discriminative listening is how babies understand the intention of a phrase before they can understand words. If someone speaks to them in a happy and amused tone of voice, they'll smile and laugh back.

They can also tell who is talking because they recognize different voices.

But discriminative listening isn't just for babies.

If you're listening to a conversation happening in a foreign language, you'll likely automatically use your discriminative listening skills.

These will allow you to analyze tone and inflection to get an idea of what is going on.

You can also use nonverbal cues to listen and analyze. For instance, someone's facial expressions, body language, and other mannerisms can tell you a lot about the meaning of someone's message.

You shouldn't discount discriminative listening, even if you understand someone's language.

This listening style is key to understanding the subtle cues in a conversation. Using this listening skill can help you read between the lines and hear what remains unspoken.

3. Biased listening

Biased listening is also known as selective listening.

Someone who uses biased listening will only listen for information that they specifically want to hear.

This listening process can lead to a distortion of facts. That's because the person listening isn't fully in tune with what the speaker wishes to communicate.

4. Sympathetic listening

Sympathetic listening is driven by emotion.

Instead of focusing on the message spoken through words, the listener focuses on the feelings and emotions of the speaker.

This is done to process these feelings and emotions.

By using sympathetic listening, you can provide the support the speaker needs. You can understand [how they're really feeling](#), not what they say they are feeling.

The speaker will feel heard and validated when you take the time to pay attention in this way.

Sympathetic listening is crucial if you want to build a deeper relationship with someone in your life.

5. Comprehensive listening

Unlike discriminative listening, comprehensive listening requires language skills.

This type of listening is usually developed in early childhood.

People use comprehensive listening to understand what someone is saying using words.

Several other types of listening build on comprehensive listening. For example, you need to use comprehensive listening to use informational listening and learn something new.

At work and in your life, you'll likely use a combination of comprehensive and discriminative listening to understand the messages people are giving you.

For example, let's say your colleague briefs you on a project. You'll need to use comprehensive listening to analyze the words and understand the message.

You'll also use comprehensive listening [when you receive feedback](#).

6. Empathetic or therapeutic listening

Empathetic listening is useful to help you see from other people's perspectives.

Using this type of listening, you can try to understand someone else's point of view as they're speaking. You can also try to imagine yourself in the other person's shoes.

Instead of just focusing on their message, you can use [empathetic listening](#) to relate to someone else's experiences as if they were your own.

This is different from sympathetic listening.

With sympathetic listening, you try to understand someone's feelings to provide support. But you don't necessarily try to imagine what it'd feel like to be in their position.

7. Critical listening

If you need to analyze complex information, you'll need to use critical listening.

Using critical thinking while listening goes deeper than comprehensive listening. Instead of taking the information at face value, you can use critical listening to evaluate what's being said.

Critical listening is crucial when problem-solving at work.

Why is listening so important in life and at work?

Listening is a key component of effective [communication skills](#).

Regardless of the type, listening is key to understanding what other people are really trying to say. Without listening, it's easy to get something wrong and make assumptions.

On the other hand, when you actively listen, you can fully communicate with someone else.

Listening is the most important part of communication. That's because it allows you to come up with a substantial and meaningful response. You can pick up on subtleties you wouldn't have otherwise, [especially with body language](#).

If something isn't clear, you can ask clarifying questions. This is something you might not have done without active listening.

At work, communication is an important soft skill. According to LinkedIn's 2019 Global Talent Trends report, 80% of companies say that soft skills are increasingly important to their success.

Listening is also important for [productive collaboration](#).

According to the same LinkedIn report, collaboration is the third most important soft skill companies need.

Imagine trying to collaborate if you can't actively listen to your colleagues. Information gets lost, and misunderstandings occur.

The same can happen if everyone on the team uses different levels of listening. Some people will be more engaged than

others. Not everyone will get the same understanding of the same conversation.

You can avoid this if everyone actively listens to each other.

Plus, when you actively listen, your colleagues and your superiors will notice that you come up with meaningful responses.

Listening is also crucial if you want to learn effectively.

Without attentive listening, it can be easy to miss small details that make a difference in your learning.

Writing Styles

Your audience and writing purpose will determine your writing style. **The four main types of writing** styles are persuasive, narrative, expository, and descriptive.

Persuasive: For this writing style, the writer is trying to convince the reader of the validity of a certain position or argument. Persuasive writing includes the writers' opinions, and provides justifications and evidence to support their claims.

Examples: Letters of recommendation; cover letters; Op-Eds and Editorial newspaper articles; argumentative essays for academic papers

Narrative: Often seen in longer writing samples, the purpose of this writing style is to share information in the context of a story. Narratives should include characters, conflicts, and settings.

Examples: Short stories; novels; poetry; historical accounts

Expository: This type of writing is used to explain a concept and share information to a broader audience. Expository writing provides evidence, statistics, or results and focuses on the facts of a certain topic. This type is not meant to express opinions.

Examples: How-to articles; textbooks; news stories (not editorials or Op-Eds); business, technical, or scientific writing

Descriptive: This type of writing is used to depict imagery to create a clear picture in the mind of the reader. This method helps the readers become more connected to the writing by appealing to their senses. Descriptive writing employs literary techniques such as similes, metaphors, allegory, etc to engage the audience.

Examples: Poetry; fictional novels or plays; memoirs or first-hand accounts of events.

Five Types of Communication

Verbal Communication

Verbal communication occurs when we engage in speaking with others. It can be face-to-face, over the telephone, via Skype or Zoom, etc. Some verbal engagements are informal, such as chatting with a friend over coffee or in the office kitchen, while others are more formal, such as a scheduled meeting. Regardless of the type, it is not just about the words, it is also about the caliber and complexity of those words, how we string those words together to create an overarching message, as well as the intonation (pitch, tone, cadence, etc.) used while speaking. And

when occurring face-to-face, while the words are important, they cannot be separated from non-verbal communication.

Non-Verbal Communication

What we do while we speak often says more than the actual words. Non-verbal communication includes facial expressions, posture, eye contact, hand movements, and touch. For example, if you're engaged in a conversation with your boss about your cost-saving idea, it is important to pay attention to both the their words and their non-verbal communication. Your boss might be in agreement with your idea verbally, but their nonverbal cues: avoiding eye contact, sighing, scrunched up face, etc. indicate something different.

Written Communication

Whether it is an email, a memo, a report, a Facebook post, a Tweet, a contract, etc. all forms of written communication have the same goal to disseminate information in a clear and concise manner – though that objective is often not achieved. In fact, poor writing skills often lead to confusion and embarrassment, and even potential legal jeopardy. One important thing to remember about written communication, especially in the digital age, is the message lives on, perhaps in perpetuity. Thus, there are two things to remember: first, write well – poorly constructed sentences and careless errors make you look bad; and second, ensure the content of the message is something you want to promote or be associated with for the long haul.

Listening

The [act of listening](#) does not often make its way onto the list of types of communication. Active listening, however, is perhaps one of the most important types of communication because if we cannot listen to the person sitting across from us, we cannot effectively engage with them. Think about a negotiation – part of the process is to assess what the opposition wants and needs. Without listening, it is impossible to assess that, which makes it difficult to achieve a win/win outcome.

Visual Communication

We are a visual society. Think about it, televisions are running 24/7, Facebook is visual with memes, videos, images, etc., Instagram is an image-only platform, and advertisers use imagery to sell products and ideas. Think about from a personal perspective – the images we post on social media are meant to convey meaning – to communicate a message. In some cases that message might be, look at me, I'm in Italy or I just won an award. Others are carefully curated to tug on our heartstrings – injured animals, crying children, etc.

The 4 types of communication styles

Broadly speaking, there are four different communication styles. Here's how each is commonly defined, as well as how these different styles can appear at work.

1. Passive communication style

A passive communicator doesn't speak up frequently. Instead, they are content to adapt and support the needs of others.

Passive communicators usually aren't confrontational, and they may even come off as submissive. Their [nonverbal communication](#) may include things like crossing their arms while avoiding eye contact.

2. Aggressive communication style

A person with this communication style is very confident in their point of view—to the point where they may not listen to their teammate's opinions. They often interject their own ideas into a conversation and may sometimes use confrontational language like “you're wrong” or “you don't get it.” In the workplace, this aggressive behavior creates tension among team members. Non-verbal communication typically includes strong eye contact, signaling dominance.

3. Passive-aggressive communication style

A person with this communication style doesn't feel comfortable saying what they mean. Their verbal and nonverbal communication may not match. For example, they may say they're excited but display contradictory body language like a frown or slumped shoulders. In the workplace, this style can lead to miscommunications and unresolved tensions.

4. Assertive communication style.

A person with this communication style stands up for themselves. They are the type of communicator who knows how to explain and advocate for what they want, others' rights, or their own well-being. Assertive communicators may use hand gestures while communicating nonverbally, and they likely have calm or joyful facial expressions while speaking. People often view this as the most effective communication style in the workplace.

Key components of a business proposal

A business proposal should include your company and services, about the team, the challenge and solution offered, testimonials, timeline, pricing , terms and deliverables.

Format of business proposal:

- Cover Page
- Executive Summary
- Table of contents
- Client Information and Signing Authority
- Engagement letter
- Scope of work and deliverables
- Services offered with pricing
- Terms and conditions

How to Write a Business Report

A business report is a collection of data and analyses that helps make relevant information easily accessible to a company. There are many different types of business reports, but this guide will show you the basic outline.

Before You Begin:

- Think about your audience and their expectations, and plan your report accordingly. For example, are they expecting a formal or informal report? Do they have an understanding of the vocabulary/terms used? Do they require more background information? Do they need to be heavily persuaded?
- What is the purpose of the report? Make sure this is clear.
- Gather and organize your supporting information/data/visuals.
- Focus on the facts.
- Make sure to be clear and concise, so the report is easy for everyone to read and understand.
- Use a professional, standard font in a readable size.

Components of a Business Report

- **Title Page**
- **Table of Contents:** Depending on the length of the report, you might want to consider including a table of contents. This will make finding specific information easier for readers.

- **Summary:** This section includes a brief overview of the main points of the report and is usually a few sentences to a paragraph in length. If someone were to read this section, they would have an idea of the main takeaways from each section of the report.
 - **Tip:** Even though this is the first section, consider writing this section after you have finished the report. This will help you determine which points are the most important to address.
- **Introduction:** This section outlines what you will be going over in your report. It includes the main points, chosen report structure, and, most importantly, the objective of your report.
- **Body:** The body is where you discuss the points of your report in detail. This section is divided by headings that inform your reader what information can be found in the following paragraph/s. The structure of this section will vary depending on the type of report, information/data you are relaying to the company, and whether or not a deep analysis is necessary.
 - Examples of headings:
 - Methods
 - Findings
 - Research
 - Analysis
 - Graphs

- **Conclusion:** In the conclusion, be sure to briefly summarize all of the main points in the order they were presented in the report.
- **Recommendations:** This section is where you provide your recommendations or suggestions based on the findings you noted in earlier sections. Indicate the potential benefits for the company to applying your suggestions.
- **References:** Be sure to cite all sources used in the report in this section.
- **Appendices:** In the Appendix, you can add relevant documents, surveys, graphs, etc. that you referenced in the report.

12 Essential Qualities of Effective Leadership

- A good leader should have integrity, self-awareness, courage, respect, compassion, and resilience. They should be learning agile and flex their influence while communicating the vision, showing gratitude, and collaborating effectively. See how these key leadership qualities can be learned and improved at all levels of your organization.

Leaders shape our teams, organizations, communities, and world.

We need good leaders to help guide us and make the essential decisions, big and small, that keep things moving forward.

Our society is usually quick to identify a bad leader, but how can you identify a good one? What would most people say are the qualities of a good leader?

What Good Leadership Looks Like

Based upon our decades of research and experience working with leaders at thousands of organizations around the world, we've found that the best leaders consistently possess certain fundamental qualities and skills. Here are 12 essential leadership traits.

1. [Self-Awareness](#)
2. [Respect](#)
3. [Compassion](#)
4. [Vision](#)
5. [Communication](#)
6. [Learning Agility](#)
7. [Collaboration](#)
8. [Influence](#)
9. [Integrity](#)
10. [Courage](#)
11. [Gratitude](#)
12. [Resilience](#)

1. Self-Awareness

Self-awareness is the understanding of yourself, including personality traits, behaviors, anxieties, and emotions. While this is a more inwardly focused trait, self-awareness and humility are

paramount qualities of leadership. The better you understand yourself and recognize your own strengths and weaknesses, the more effective you can be as a leader. Do you know how other people view you and understand how you show up at work and at home? Take the time to learn about [the 4 aspects of self-awareness](#) and how to strengthen each component.

2. Respect

Respect, when demonstrated consistently, is one of the most important things a leader can do. It helps ease tensions and conflict, fosters trust, and improves your effectiveness. [Creating a culture of respect](#) is about more than just the absence of disrespect. Respectfulness can be shown in many different ways, but it often starts with showing you truly value others' perspectives and making an effort to [build belonging in the workplace](#) — both critical components of supporting equity, diversity, and inclusion.

3. Compassion

Compassion is more than simply showing empathy or even listening and seeking to understand. Compassion requires leaders to *act* on what they learn. After someone shares a concern or speaks up about something, they won't feel truly heard if their leader doesn't then take some type of meaningful action on the information, our researchers have found. This is the core of [compassionate leadership](#), and it helps to build trust, increase collaboration, and decrease turnover across organizations.

4. Vision

Vision is your aspiration for the future. Motivating others and garnering commitment toward that vision are essential parts of leadership. [Purpose-driven leaders](#) ensure they connect their team's daily tasks and the values of individual team members to the overall direction of the organization. This can help employees find meaning in their work — which increases engagement, inspires trust, and drives priorities forward. You'll want to [communicate the vision](#) in ways that help others understand it, remember it, and go on to share it themselves.

5. Communication

Communication shows up in many ways, from transmitting information and storytelling to soliciting input and using [active listening techniques](#). [Effective leadership and effective communication are intertwined](#). The best leaders are skilled communicators who can communicate in a variety of ways, both orally and in writing, and with a wide range of people from different backgrounds, roles, levels, geographies, and more. The quality and effectiveness of communication among leaders at your organization will directly affect the success of your business strategy, too.

6. Learning Agility

Learning agility is the ability to know what to do when you don't know what to do. If you're a "quick study" or are able to excel in unfamiliar circumstances, you might already be learning agile. But anybody can [foster and increase learning agility](#)

through intentional practice and effort. After all, great leaders are really great learners.

7. Collaboration

Collaboration is a characteristic shown when leaders work effectively with a variety of colleagues of different [social identities](#), locations, roles, and experiences. As the world has become more complex and interconnected, good leaders find themselves [spanning boundaries](#) and learning to work across various types of divides and organizational silos. When leaders value and embrace collaboration, whether within their teams or cross-functionally, several benefits arise — including increased innovation, higher-performing teams, and a more engaged and empowered workforce.

8. Influence

Influence, or being able to persuade people through thoughtful use of appropriate [influencing tactics](#), is an important trait of inspiring, effective leaders. For some people, “influence” may sound unseemly. But as a leader, you must be able to influence others to get the work done — you cannot do it all alone.

Influence is quite different from manipulation, and it needs to be done authentically and transparently. It requires high levels of emotional intelligence and trust.

9. Integrity

Integrity is being consistent, honest, moral, and trustworthy, and it's an essential leadership trait for the individual and the organization. It's especially important for top-level executives

who are charting the organization's course and making countless other significant decisions. Our research has found that leader [integrity is a potential blind spot for organizations](#), so make sure you reinforce the importance of honesty and integrity to managers at all levels.

10. Courage

Courage enables both team members and leaders to take bold actions that move things in the right direction. It can be hard to speak up at work, whether you want to voice a new idea, provide feedback to a direct report, or flag a concern for someone above you. That's part of the reason courage is a key leadership trait — it takes courage to do what's right! Leaders who promote high levels of [psychological safety in the workplace](#) enable their people to speak up freely and share candid concerns without fear of repercussions. This fosters a [coaching culture that supports courage and truth-telling](#).

11. Gratitude

Gratitude is the uplifting emotion experienced after receiving something of value. Being thankful can lead to higher self-esteem, reduced depression and anxiety, and better sleep. Sincere gratitude can even make you a better leader. Yet few people regularly say “thank you” in work settings, even though most people say they'd be willing to work harder for an appreciative boss. The best leaders know how to show frequent [gratitude in the workplace](#).

12. Resilience

Resilience is more than the ability to bounce back from obstacles and setbacks — it's the ability to respond adaptively to challenges. [Practicing resilient leadership](#) means you'll project a positive outlook that will help others maintain the emotional strength they need to commit to a shared vision, and the courage to move forward and overcome setbacks. A good leader focuses on resilience, both taking care of themselves and also prioritizing [leading employee wellbeing](#), too — thereby enabling better performance for themselves and their teams.

Unit -3

[Corporate social responsibility](#) (CSR) is a business initiative designed to meet specific goals related to ethics, sustainability and social impact. When executed well, it can enhance how your business is viewed and approached, helping to share your company's broader mission with the world.

1. Environmental social responsibility
2. Ethical/human rights social responsibility
3. Philanthropic corporate responsibility

4. Economic corporate responsibility

Types of corporate social responsibility

CSR is generally categorized in four ways: environmental responsibility, ethical/human rights responsibility, philanthropic responsibility and economic responsibility. Here, we're going to examine each one.

1. Environmental corporate responsibility

Environmental responsibility refers to the organization's commitment to sustainability and environmentally friendly operations.

Every year, more companies are prioritizing sustainable practices, pledging to consider their environmental impact at every stage of business.

This can mean reducing the company's carbon footprint or greenhouse gas emissions, opting for sustainable resources by avoiding single-use plastics and keeping environmental aspects at the heart of all operations.

However, this environmental responsibility can extend past the company's promise to sustainable development. If protecting the environment is a part of your corporate mission, you can honor that by encouraging employees to take action.

Follow along to learn how each type can engage employees, improve branding and make a positive social impact.

2. Ethical/human rights social responsibility

Ethical responsibility refers to a company's commitment to operate their business in an ethical manner that upholds human rights principles, such as fair treatment of all stakeholders, fair trade practices and equal pay.

To champion ethical responsibility, many businesses will speak up in the name of human rights injustices such as child labor, racial or gender discrimination and the fight for a higher minimum wage.

Much like with responsibility to the environment, there are ways to endorse ethics at your company by involving employees in the process.

3. Philanthropic corporate responsibility

Philanthropic responsibility refers to a corporation's aims, goals and objectives for actively bettering society as a whole. One huge aspect of corporate philanthropy is donating money from company earnings to worthy causes within the local community — often in the form of a trust or foundation.

These kinds of philanthropic efforts speak volumes to your public image as a business leader, which is crucial in today's world. There are several ways in which businesses can incorporate CSR in the form of philanthropy while engaging employees, including giving schemes with the potential for donation matching.

4. Economic corporate responsibility

Economic responsibility refers to the practice of making financial decisions based on a commitment to doing good.

Some common examples of economic responsibility include investing in alternative energy sources, putting more money into education programs and funding local charities as a way of bolstering their mission.

To uphold economic responsibility, business leaders are challenged to think past operational cost savings and instead put their obligation to corporate citizenship at the heart of all financial decisions.

Principles of Corporate Ethics

Understanding and implementing ethical principles is fundamental for both individuals and businesses. These principles serve as guiding lights, steering decisions and behaviours toward integrity, fairness, and responsibility. Failure to adhere to ethical standards can lead to the downfall of not just individuals but entire organizations. Let's delve into each of the 12 Corporate Ethics principles in detail:

- 1. Leadership:** Ethical leadership involves consciously integrating and embodying the other 11 principles into decision-making processes. Leaders set the tone for ethical behaviour within an organization, influencing both employees and stakeholders.

2. **Accountability:** Holding oneself and others responsible for their actions is essential for maintaining ethical standards. This principle emphasizes the commitment to following ethical practices and ensuring that others within the organization do the same.
3. **Integrity:** Integrity encompasses honesty, trustworthiness, and reliability. Individuals with integrity consistently do the right thing, even when it's difficult, and strive to uphold themselves to a higher standard of behaviour.
4. **Respect for Others:** Building an ethical workplace environment involves respecting the dignity, privacy, and equality of all individuals. This principle promotes compassion and empathy towards colleagues, customers, and the community at large.
5. **Honesty:** Truthfulness in all matters is crucial for fostering trust and transparency. It involves communicating both good and bad news openly and honestly, without withholding information or distorting the truth.
6. **Respect for Laws:** Ethical leadership includes compliance with all relevant laws and regulations. Leaders should prioritize legality over exploiting legal grey areas to ensure fairness and justice.
7. **Responsibility:** Encouraging a culture of ownership and accountability within the organization empowers employees to take

responsibility for their actions and outcomes. Leaders should lead by example and hold themselves accountable for their decisions.

8. **Transparency:** Transparency involves sharing relevant information with stakeholders, such as shareholders, employees, and the community, without compromising confidentiality or trade secrets. Open communication fosters trust and accountability.
9. **Compassion:** Demonstrating concern for the well-being of others, including employees, customers, and the broader community, is integral to ethical behaviour. Compassion promotes empathy and understanding in all interactions.
10. **Fairness:** Ensuring fairness involves treating all individuals with equality and respect, regardless of their background or status. Fair practices promote trust and cohesion within the organization.
11. **Loyalty:** Ethical leaders demonstrate loyalty to their employees and the company by maintaining confidentiality and fostering a sense of commitment and dedication among team members.
12. **Environmental Concern:** In today's world, businesses must consider the environmental impact of their operations. Environmental concern involves awareness of ecological issues and a commitment to

sustainable practices to minimize harm to the planet.

What is business etiquette?

Business etiquette is a type of behavior that team members are expected to follow in order to uphold the company image and respect each other. Business etiquette may change from culture to culture, but when everyone understands and follows a particular set of standards, it can create a sense of unity.

Business etiquette is sometimes unspoken, but more often than not, team members will agree upon the basic rules so everyone presents a united image. When team members follow business etiquette, it builds [effective communication in the workplace](#).

The 5 basics of business etiquette

The basics of business etiquette vary from culture to culture, and it can be particularly intimidating to understand business etiquette if you're working for a company with a culture different from the one you grew up in. However, there are some universal constants that can help you stick to the status quo as you learn the particular [group dynamics](#) and team norms at your company.

These five important business courtesies can help you make a solid first impression and show respect for your team members.

1. Be on time

Whether you're attending an interview or daily [standup meeting](#), being on time in a work environment shows that you respect everyone's schedule. If punctuality isn't something you've prioritized in the past, brush up on some [time management tips](#) to keep yourself organized and aware of your [to-do list](#).

There are nuances to being on time—some cultures operate on a system of being slightly late to everything. But when in doubt, show up on time and adjust from there if necessary.

2. Recognize your team

Acknowledging others is proper business etiquette for both casual and formal work environments. When someone walks in the room at a business dinner or meeting, greet them and say hello appropriately—whether by shaking hands or following some other cultural custom.

The same rule applies if you work from home and attend daily Zoom meetings. You may not be required to get on camera in every business meeting, but speaking up and taking the time to recognize your team members can let everyone know you're listening and make others feel noticed.

3. Dress appropriately

Dressing appropriately is subjective and will depend on whether you work in an office or from home. Some companies that work in the office every day will expect everyone to dress in business

casual attire because much of the work involves face time with [stakeholders](#) or clients. Other companies who work in a hybrid environment may encourage team members to dress casually in order to promote comfort and [productivity](#).

If you are unsure about appropriate business attire, ask your manager or supervisor for tips. It's especially common to feel unsure if you just started a new job, but don't be afraid to send a quick email before your first day to get a feel of the office policy. Alternatively, think back to your interview and try to remember what everyone was wearing so you can dress accordingly.

4. Respect shared spaces

Even if you work remotely, you may go into the office on occasion or share virtual spaces with your team members. Office spaces you may share with team members include a kitchen, bathroom, printer and copy room, and lounge area. Virtual spaces you may share include Google Drive folders and [project management software](#).

The way you treat shared spaces will reflect on you as a professional, so it's important that you label things correctly, stay organized, and respect others who also use these spaces. Business etiquette applies to shared spaces whether you're cleaning up after yourself physically or following company processes online.

5. Build emotional intelligence

[Emotional intelligence](#) is the ability to recognize, regulate, and understand emotions in yourself and in others. Effective emotional intelligence skills can help you empathize with team members and overcome challenges. While emotional intelligence isn't a direct rule of business etiquette, it will help you in the workplace, no matter what conflicts arise.

For example, imagine you're behind on work and your boss suddenly adds a large, time-sensitive project to your plate. With emotional intelligence skills, you can speak with your manager to understand the relative priority of the work. Since you're already behind on work, you can express your worry about becoming [overworked](#) and work with your manager to come up with a solution of which work you can deprioritize or [delegate](#) less important tasks.

Business etiquette for remote workers

With the transition to increasingly [virtual teams](#), the definition and practice of business etiquette has changed. In person, you may need a politely firm handshake and the right attire, but when [working remotely](#), you'll need to know the basics of email, phone, and video etiquette.

Email and team communication etiquette

Writing an email or communicating with your team through online differs from personal communication. Consider the tips below for proper email and online etiquette.

- **Proofread:** Proofreading your emails is a hard rule of thumb that you shouldn't ignore. While your email or project management platform may have a built-in proofreading tool, you should also look over your email before sending it out, just in case.
- **Be polite and professional:** Even though you're not speaking face to face with your email recipient, your tone of voice will come through in your words. It's important to be polite and professional in your copy. For example, you can use upbeat phrases like: "I hope you... thanks for... just a friendly reminder... please let me know... looking forward to hearing from you."
- **Respond in a timely manner:** Whenever another team member or client reaches out to you, they're doing so for a reason. Proper email and team communication etiquette means responding to people in a timely manner, even if that means setting up an automatic response for when you're out of the office. While you don't need to respond within minutes, aim to respond within one or two business days.
- **Keep it brief:** Keeping your email copy brief can get your point across quickly and save time for your reader. When you hide the main objective of your message within a lengthy email, your reader may be less likely to respond in the way you hope for.

Remember that who you're writing to may make a difference in your email or online content. For example, if you're communicating with other team members through Asana and Slack, you can write in a more casual tone, whereas client emails should be more formal.

Phone etiquette

Business communication often occurs through phone calls. When speaking to clients or business partners on the phone, consider the following ways to uphold business etiquette.

- **Don't call unannounced:** Everyone in the business world has a schedule to follow, whether they're working around a strict [project timeline](#) or trying to [prioritize](#) a heavy workload. When you need to talk to someone on the phone, send them an email first to schedule your call. Calling unannounced can be considered bad manners because the call recipient may be unprepared to talk to you.
- **Use reasonable tone and clarity:** Your tone of voice is important on work phone calls. You'll need to keep a polite tone as you speak to team members or clients and be aware of your volume and clarity as well. If you speak too loudly or mumble on a professional call, your recipient may not receive your message the way you hope them to. Tone and communication can also vary based on culture, so keep [cultural intelligence](#) in mind when on the phone.
- **Deliver messages promptly:** Just like with work emails, it's important to respond to work voicemails promptly. You may receive emails from team members or clients asking to schedule phone calls. Respond to these emails quickly with the best time you're available to talk on the phone.

- **Create a professional voicemail:** Creating a professional voicemail for when you're unavailable is proper business etiquette because it lets people know who you are, what you do, and that you're unavailable. They can then leave you messages explaining why they're calling.

Video etiquette

Video is one of the most popular ways for remote workers to connect. With this method of communication, you get the benefit of speaking with many of your team members in real-time, which means there are some video etiquette basics you should know.

- **Mute yourself:** One of the biggest issues team members face on video calls is background noise coming from those who aren't speaking. This issue has a simple fix: mute yourself when you aren't the speaker. Muting yourself will ensure your microphone is silent so others can have the full attention of the virtual room.
- **Engage with your body:** When on a video call, others can see how you non-verbally interact with the speaker. If you're looking down or you're too relaxed in your seat, you may send the message that you're uninterested in the conversation. Sitting up straight, looking alert, and using [nonverbal communication](#) to show you're engaged lets the speaker know you're paying attention.
- **Don't interrupt:** Interrupting someone on a video call can be especially disruptive. Technology can't always keep up with multiple people trying to speak on a video call, so interruptions can lead to glitches and confusion for everyone involved.

- **Dress appropriately:** Video calls may only show your clothes from the waist up, but it's still important to dress appropriately together. Your attire for video calls should follow your company's dress code. Also consider your personal hygiene when on camera.

[Working from home](#) makes it less common that you'll interact with team members and clients in person, but don't forget that virtual interactions still leave lasting impressions. When in doubt, approach these interactions with the same business etiquette and care as you would for an in-person conversation.

Improve team communication with business etiquette

The goal of business etiquette is to present a united company image, foster mutual respect for team members, and improve communication in the workplace. When teams communicate effectively, they do better work.